

What the System Remembers: The First Promise

系统记住了什么：第一次承诺

Theme: 科学、技术与互联网 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The first promise of the arc was made in the innovation lab, with a **keyboard**, a **mouse**, and a **printer** on the table. “Every **system** we **access** will have an **argument** behind it,” Maya said. “A **program** is not a promise; a promise is a **program** with a reason.” We would take the third position: not the base of the **network**, but the **code** at the door.

The **physics** of the promise was simple: **energy** in, **data** out, and no **chemical** left behind. A **cell** of six volunteers, a **machine** that nobody had switched off, and an **operation** manual in a **format** nobody could read: the effort of the first week was to leave nothing open. “You cannot **calculate** trust,” the engineer said. “You can only **monitor** it.”

The event that made it urgent was a **virus**. A **bug** in the **driver**, a **worm** in the **backup**, and a **crash** of the **printer** on the night before the launch: the **track** of the damage led to a **dump** of old files that had never been registered. “A **scanner** is not a conscience,” Aisha wrote. “An **indicator** is not a control.”

The position was difficult, and it had to be provided in writing. Every **device**, every **software** package, and every **online** service would have a named person responsible for it; the **hardware** in the lab would be inventoried, and the **logic** of every **access** rule would be explained to the volunteers in one page.

The **technology** was not the point, and even the **biotechnology** group in the next building knew it. A **hacker** in **cyberspace**, a **register** of permissions, and a **network** that remembered more than any human could: thus the **phase** of the design had to begin with deletion. “Create less,” Lin wrote, “and the **Internet** will have less to remember.” It was a promise about forgetting, and it arrived on time. We have a difficult effort ahead: to create a base, to take the third pass at the **code**, and to reach a position we can provide in writing. Down the corridor the night shift was playing music, or at least something like it. Thus the event of the launch had to leave a year of work in a form that could survive us. A **computer**, a **source**, a **science**, and an **engineering** team: the club had none of them, and the **code** was written by volunteers.

中文翻译

这段弧线的第一个承诺是在创新实验室里做出的，桌上放着一个键盘、一只鼠标和一台打印机。“我们访问的每一个系统背后都要有一个论证，”曼雅说，“程序不是承诺；承诺是一个有理由的程序。”我们将采取第三种立场：不是网络的底座，而是门口的代码。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
system 'sɪstəm POS: n	n. 系统, 体系, 制度, 方式, 秩序, 分类原则; [计] 系统; 体制; 体系 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. instrumentality that combines interrelated interacting artifacts designed to work as a coherent entity; n. ...
program 'prəʊgræm POS: n	n. 节目, 节目单, 程序, 纲要, 大纲, 计划; vt. 规划, 拟...计划; vi. 安排节目, 编程序; [计] 程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a system of projects or services intended to meet a public need; n. an announcement of the events that will...
data 'deɪtə POS: review required	pl. 资料, 数据; [计] 数据; DOS内部命令:用于显示或设定系统的日期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a collection of facts from which conclusions may be drawn
computer kəm'pjʊ:tə POS: n	n. 电脑, 电子计算机; [计] 计算机 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a machine for performing calculations automatically
technology tek'nɒlədʒi POS: n	n. 技术, 工业技术, 术语; [医] 技术学, 工艺学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the practical application of science to commerce or industry
source sɔ:s POS: n	n. 来源, 水源, 根源, 原始资料, 源; [计] 来源, 源程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a document (or organization) from which information is obtained; n. anything that provides inspiration for...
energy 'enədʒi POS: n	n. 精力, 精神, 活力, 能量; [化] 能; 能量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (physics) a thermodynamic quantity equivalent to the capacity of a physical system to do work; the units o...
operation .əpe'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 操作, 动作, 手术, 运算, 作用, 业务; [计] 运算 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being in effect or being operative; n. a business especially one run on a large scale; n. a pla...
machine mə'ʃi:n POS: n	n. 机器, 机械装置, 机构, 自动售货机, 机械般工作的人; vt. 以机器制造 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any mechanical or electrical device that transmits or modifies energy to perform or assist in the performa...
cell sel POS: n	n. 单元, 细胞, 电池; [计] 单元 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any small compartment; n. (biology) the basic structural and functional unit of all organisms; they may exi...
science 'saɪəns POS: n	n. 科学, 学科, 学问, 自然科学; [医] 科学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a particular branch of scientific knowledge
argument 'ɑ:gjʊmənt POS: n	n. 争论, 论证, 论据, 自变量; [计] 参数 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fact or assertion offered as evidence that something is true; n. a discussion in which reasons are advanc...
network 'netwɜ:k POS: n	n. 网络, 广播网, 网状物; [计] 网络 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an interconnected system of things or people; n. (broadcasting) a communication system consisting of a grou...
access 'ækses POS: n	n. 通路, 入口, 接近, 进入, 使用权, 发件; vt. 访问, 存取, 接近, 使用; [计] 访问, 存取 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the right to obtain

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phase feɪz POS: n	n. 时期, 局面, 方面, 位相, 相, 阶段; vt. 使调整相位, 使定相, 使一致, 逐步执行, 实行; [计] 阶段 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any distinct time period in a sequence of events; n. (physical chemistry) a distinct state of matter in a s...
engineering ˌendʒɪˈnɪərɪŋ POS: n	n. 工程学, 工程, 操纵; [化] 机器; 机器学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the discipline dealing with the art or science of applying scientific knowledge to practical problems; n. a...
calculate ˈkælkjuleɪt POS: v	v. 计算, 预测, 计划, 打算 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make a mathematical calculation or computation; v. judge to be probable; v. specifically design a product, e...
online phonetic unavailable POS: review required	[计] 联机 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a on a regular route of a railroad or bus or airline system; a connected to a computer network or accessible b...
monitor ˈmɒnɪtə POS: n	n. 监督器, 级长, 监听员, 班长, 监视器, 告诫物; v. 监视, 监听, 监督; [计] 监视器, 监视程序; 监视 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an ironclad vessel built by Federal forces to do battle with the Merrimac; n. display produced by a device...
register ˈredʒɪstə POS: n	n. 寄存器, 记录, 登记簿, 注册; vt. 记录, 注册, 提示, 表达, 把...挂号; vi. 登记, 注册, 挂号; [计] 寄存器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an official written record of names or events or transactions; n. (music) the timbre that is characteristic...
chemical ˈkemɪkl POS: n	n. 化学药品; a. 化学的, 化学上用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. material produced by or used in a reaction involving changes in atoms or molecules; a. relating to or used...
virus ˈvaɪərəs POS: n	n. 病毒, 滤过性病毒, 毒害; [化] 病毒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (virology) ultramicroscopic infectious agent that replicates itself only within cells of living hosts; man...
crash kræʃ POS: n	n. 哗啦声, 猛撞, 崩溃, 粗布; v. 撞碎, 破碎, (使)...坠毁; a. 速成的; [计] 崩溃 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a serious accident (usually involving one or more vehicles); n. a sudden large decline of business or the p...
mouse maʊs POS: n	n. 老鼠, 胆小羞怯的人, 鼠标; vi. 捕鼠, 窥探; vt. 探出; [计] 鼠标 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of numerous small rodents typically resembling diminutive rats having pointed snouts and small ears on...
printer ˈprɪntə POS: n	n. 印刷工, 打印机; [计] 打印机 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone whose occupation is printing; n. (computer science) an output device that prints the results of dat...
format ˈfɔ:mæt POS: n	n. 开本, 版式, 形式, 格式; vt. 格式化; [计] 格式; DOS外部命令:对磁盘进行格式化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the organization of information according to preset specifications (usually for computer processing); n. th...
logic ˈlɒd	

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
backup 'bækʌp POS: n	n. 倒车, 后退, 后援, 支持, 阻塞; vt. 做备份; a. 候补的, 支持的; [计] 备份; DOS外部命令:通常使用于将硬磁盘上指... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an accumulation caused by clogging or a stoppage; n. (computer science) a copy of a file or directory on a...
scanner 'skæənə POS: n	n. 扫描仪, 扫描盘, 审视者; [计] 扫描器; 词法分析程序; 扫描程序; 扫视程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who scans verse to determine the number and prosodic value of the syllables; n. an electronic device...
biotechnology 'baɪəutek'nɒlədʒi POS: n	n. 生物工艺学; 生物技术 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the branch of molecular biology that studies the use of microorganisms to perform specific industrial processes...
hacker 'hækə POS: review required	[计] 计算机窃贼, 计算机新技术挑战者, 黑客 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who plays golf poorly; n. a programmer who breaks into computer systems in order to steal or change...
cyberspace phonetic unavailable POS: review required	[计] 空间, 网控空间 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a computer network consisting of a worldwide network of computer networks that use the TCP/IP network protocols...